it. But, as we've noted, the princes, especially Murad and Daniyal, had been shackled by Akbar himself, fostered and dependent on the seductive riches of the court, and the velvet-smooth courtesies of young courtiers with ambition. He had bound them inexorably to his own will, appointed ataliqs to govern them, even when they were men in their mid-twenties, with growing families of their own. As a result of this, they would not be the men their father expected them to be.

Soon after the fire in Lahore, Akbar, Salim, and the court proceeded to Kashmir, this time accompanied by Fathers Jerome Xavier and Benoist Goes. The Jesuits were charmed by the 'groves, orchards, gardens' of Kashmir and wrote of the flocks of wild geese which had arrived in Srinagar from the mountains of Afghanistan, settling in exotic abundance on the rivers of the capital. They wrote of wheat and rice grown in the country, and vines planted at the foot of the mulberry trees, so that bunches of pale green grapes hung from the branches of the trees. The leaves of the mulberry trees were used to grow silk worms, the eggs of which were brought from Tibet and Gilgit. The wine from the grapes was deemed 'sour and inferior' by Salim, though he recognized that 'after gulping down several goblets of it [the Kashmiris] get really excited'.

Between 1597 and 1600, when Salim would openly revolt, tensions continued to simmer between Akbar and Salim, beneath the allure of the clustering flowers and the soothing streams. Abu'l Fazl cryptically mentions several incidents when Salim or his attendants indulged in 'improper' actions, for which they were reprimanded by the Padshah, who then seemed to be overtaken by remorse, and tried to make amends. In one instance, a man who had spoken rudely to Salim had the tip of his tongue cut off on Akbar's order.

The Mughal family was struck by a number of personal tragedies at this time. Daniyal's young bride, the daughter of Qulic Khan, gave birth to a baby boy who died soon after. Murad's nine-year-old son Rustam, who was being raised by his imperial grandparents, also died. Infant deaths were remarkably common during this period, occurring all around the country as the wives accompanied their restless husbands in the travelling camps. Moosvi has studied the alarming rate of infant mortality in the Mughal family, rated as 'exceptionally high' at 43.3 per cent, especially when compared to British ducal families of the same period, which had infant mortality rates of just 31.5 per cent. The Mughal infants would have